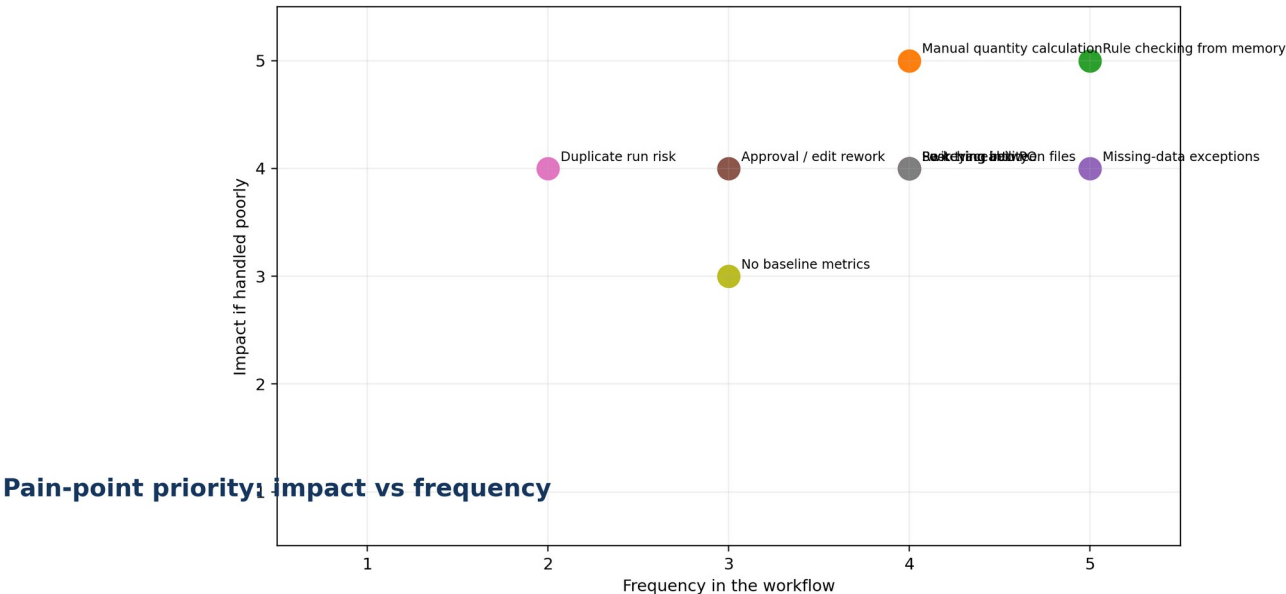


Pain Point and Root Cause Analysis

Sources of delay, error and review effort

Purpose. Identify the main sources of friction in purchase-order preparation and connect each pain point to a measurable test or outcome.



1. Pain-point register

ID	Pain point	Root cause	Risk	Measure
P1	Data is split across several files	The buyer repeatedly switches context and may use inconsistent versions.	Longer time; wrong input version	File switches; lookup time
P2	The same checks are repeated for every SKU	Process knowledge lives in the buyer rather than the workflow.	Fatigue; skipped checks	Checks per SKU; missed-rule count
P3	Quantity adjustment rules are easy to apply inconsistently	Raw need and final order quantity are different concepts.	Wrong order quantity	Quantity-error rate
P4	Supplier / price gaps are often discovered late	Commercial validation happens after replenishment logic.	Rework; blocked PO late in process	Time-to-first-blocker

ID	Pain point	Root cause	Risk	Measure
P5	PO preparation requires re-keying	Data is transferred manually from working files to final structure.	Typing errors; wasted effort	Transfer / edit count
P6	Exceptions can disappear in an “all good” output	Focus on successful lines can hide unresolved items.	False sense of completeness	Blocked-SKU recall
P7	Approval can become stale after a critical edit	A previously reviewed draft may no longer match the approved state.	Control failure	Post-edit re-review rate
P8	Reruns can create duplicate work	Repeated generation without a run identity can produce another active draft.	Duplicate PO risk	Duplicate-draft rate
P9	Little evidence is captured about why a line exists	Reviewer must reconstruct reasoning from raw files.	Slow review; weak audit trail	Traceability completeness

2. Root-cause grouping

Theme	Pain points	Interpretation
Information friction	P1, P4, P9	Data is available, but the user must find, align and interpret it repeatedly.
Decision friction	P2, P3	Rules are carried mentally and applied SKU by SKU.
Transfer friction	P5	A decision must be re-entered into another structure.
Control friction	P6, P7, P8	The workflow does not naturally preserve exceptions, approval state and rerun identity.

3. Pain-to-test traceability

Pain point	Test	Evidence of improvement
P1	Manual baseline + action log	Fewer file switches and lookups in agent run.
P3	MOQ / pack / quantity scenarios	Correct final quantity against agreed expected answer.
P4	Missing price / supplier scenarios	Blocker appears early and remains visible.

Pain point	Test	Evidence of improvement
P5	Manual vs agent action count	Fewer transfers / edits.
P6	Mixed valid + blocked scenario	Blocked SKU remains in exception list.
P7	Critical edit after approval	Status returns to Needs Review.
P8	Repeat same run	Only one active draft.
P9	Traceability scenario	Reviewer can identify source / reason without reopening raw files.

4. Additional operational measures

Exception discovery latency: time from run start until the buyer is shown the first blocking issue. Earlier discovery reduces wasted downstream work.

Review reconstruction effort: number of times the reviewer must reopen raw files or recalculate a value to understand a PO line. This directly measures whether the agent is making review easier, not just preparation faster.